BRIJINDER NATH'S BOOK OF ARTFUL CATS



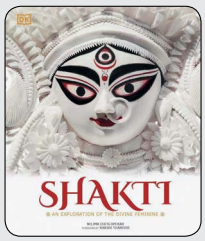
THE INDIAN CAT
Stories, Paintings, Poetry & Proverbs
By B.N. Goswamy
ALEPH
₹1,299; 240 pages

The venerable art historian B.N. Goswamy's last work, *The Indian Cat* explores the depiction of cats in Indian culture

The distinguished art historian B.N. Goswamy, sadly and recently deceased, has produced a delightful tribute to the feline tribe. Whatever the reader may feel about these small furry entities, this book will provide insights, revelations, wisdom and much gentle wit.

A chapter of general observations is followed by one section each on stories, on colour reproductions of paintings, on poems and finally proverbs. The India-specific focus is what makes the collection unique. Despite copious anecdotes in Indian folk tales, the author tells us that cats have never been the subject of any traditional or historical texts.

Shakti: An Exploration of the Divine Feminine (DK India) is a lavishly illustrated book written by Nilima Chitgopekar. It navigates through six chapters, the different manifestations of the Eternal Goddess encompassing topics from the Introduction to the Goddess to the Evolution of Goddess Worship, Buddhist and Jain Goddesses, Tantra and the Goddess, and Divine Landscapes. It traces the evolution of the divine feminine concept and culminates in present-day perspectives. The clever mix of visuals from paintings, sculptures, photographs and illustrations vividly captures the essence of the Devi, who can be nurturing, all-powerful, even terrifying. The glossary is a gem, illustrating various aspects of Indic religions, metaphors, allegories, and important concepts. Another highlight is the inclusion of the lesser-known Devis, such as the dancing goddess Vajra Yogini. What makes the book particularly enjoyable is its exploration of goddesses from the Jain, Buddhist, and Hindu pantheons, presented through an easy communicative manner. The inclusive approach adds a wonderful depth to the narrative.



A WRITER'S READS

Ways of Seeing

From a book on the Eternal Goddess to one on jali screens, 2023 was a sensorial feast for art historian and curator ***Dr Alka Pande***

